



IRCTC is the railways pride and joy, and is the most popular government site on the list

reinforcing the fact that we're probably using the Net to vent repressed frustrations.

After that, we have a lot of scattered "porn sites" (for lack of a better way of categorising them) in the top 100. You have PicsCrazy at 50 (popular for hosting adult still images that are linked to from forums like XBoard.us), Savita Bhabi at

59, Indian Sex Stories at 64, YourFileHost at 70, and Free Sexy Indian forum at 84.

Torrents Of Data

Mininova.org and Torrentz.com are the top Bit Torrent sites at 29 and 33, respectively. Though The Pirate Bay is also popular, it's a distant third at 51, with ISOHunt fourth at 60. What this means is that although the majority of bandwidth is used up *torrenting*, this is not so for us Indians. Again, this is an expected phenomenon because of the scarcity of broadband connections, and absolutely no *unlimited* broadband schemes worth talking about.

Save The Best For Last

IRCTC.co.in (used to book rail tickets online) is at 25, and this tells us that the Government hit the jackpot with that site at least. The Indian Railways site at 30 is the next government site in the list, so other government agencies should take a leaf out of the railways' book to start offering more important e-services. Understandably, Microsoft.com comes in at 14, because we all use their products—paid for or otherwise. Naukri.com at 15, Monster India at 23 and Times Jobs at 38, are interesting, because that tells us that most of us Indians seem to always be on the lookout for bigger and better opportunities—as we should be!

ICICI Bank is the most popular online, ranked at 32, followed by HDFC at 40. Download.com is our preferred software source at 36, and Reliance makes its presence felt with broadband services at 45 and Zapak at 39. BSNL comes in at 48, and rounds up all the noteworthy sites. You can of course check for changes in the pecking order at Alexa, to keep yourself abreast of the changes.

What Does It Mean?

Now that we're done with telling you what ranks where, let's try and make some sense out of the madness that is the Internet. For one thing, we've been following the list for some time now, and it's

quite obvious that India is obsessed with adult content. Even if you're not addicted to it, you just can't seem to stop yourself from clicking on that suggestive, naughty-looking link and getting an eyeful. Although sites like YouPorn are on and off the top 100 list, voyeurism, it seems, is the order of the day. No one wants *firangi* porn any more, that's just boring... Indians would rather look for *scandals*, and play peeping tom with other Indians. Whether the poor state of sex education, our repressive laws, the so called moral-police, or even the media are responsible for causing this craving for titillation is beyond the scope of this article. The fact remains that it is true, because remember, statistics don't lie.

Based on data from various torrent watchers, the most popular file formats on the network are AVI and MP3. And it's not just the MPAA and RIAA that we're ripping off—because a lot of the content being downloaded is made by the adult film industry. More porn. Sigh!

When we compare this data to the rest of the world, we find that the first adult site comes in at rank 35, with the big guys (Google, Yahoo! and Microsoft) ruling the roost. There's also more in terms of constructive usage, though, and sites like Flickr, Craigslist, BBC, Adobe, DeviantArt, and more actually featuring in the list. Obviously porn and

torrent sites feature too, but they don't seem to be too much of a priority for the rest of the world.

What Does It Mean?

With all that data being torrent-ed, and ISPs buckling under massive amounts of data transfer, who do you think suffers? If there's one big reason why you cannot spend all your free time on YouTube, it's the BitTorrent network! It's gotten so bad that ISPs, even in bandwidth heavens like the US and Japan, are starting to impose data transfer limits on their customers. So what makes you think that ISPs here are ever going to let us click-happy Indians get in on any of the 10 Mbps *unlimited* goodness?

As far as adult oriented content goes, what you do in your home is your business. But if you start clicking pictures of un-suspecting people, violating their privacy and sharing the pictures in order to become popular on a stupid forum... you've just digressed to a lower life form. Sadly, the Internet has become just another Window to peep through and satiate our various fetishes. Hopefully, this is all just a phase, and we will all outgrow this criminal behaviour. Until then, we're going to have to make do with bandwidth limitations, and protect our loved ones from voyeurs. We can all start with leading by example...☒

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